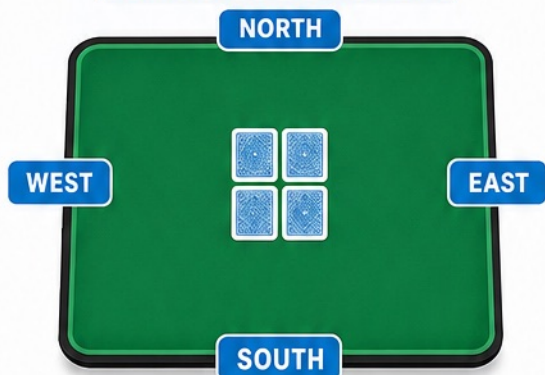




FIGB

LESSON 00: BRIDGE – A TRICK-TAKING GAME

1. THE 4 POSITIONS



2. THE 4 SUITS



Spades



Hearts



Diamonds



Clubs

3. BIDDING HIERARCHY

NT



>



>



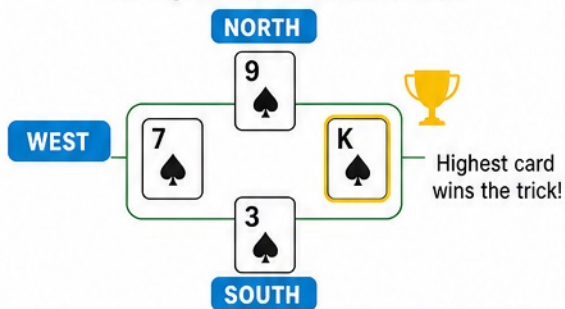
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NT > ♠ > ♥ > ♦ > ♣

4. WHAT IS A TRICK?

4 cards are played (one by each player).
The highest card wins the trick.



5. THE CONTRACT

The contract is the partnership's commitment
to take a certain number of tricks.

3NT
= 9 TRICKS

There are 13 tricks in a deal.
In No Trump (NT), you need 9 or more
tricks to make 3NT.

6. ROLES



DECLARER

Plays their cards
plus their partner's
cards (the DUMMY).



DUMMY



DEFENDERS

The other two players
(opponents).



7. BASIC SCORING – PART-SCORE SUMMARY

Common part-score contracts and their
minimum tricks needed to make.

3NT

9
TRICKS

4♥

10
TRICKS

4♠

10
TRICKS

5♣

11
TRICKS

5♦

11
TRICKS



Score points when you make your contract.
Score bonus points when you overtrick!

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LESSON 01: WINNERS AND ESTABLISHABLE CARDS

1 WINNING CARD

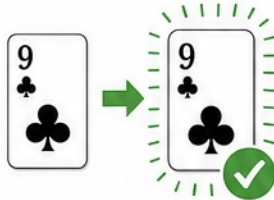
If played now, it will surely win.

Example: the Ace



2 ESTABLISHABLE CARD

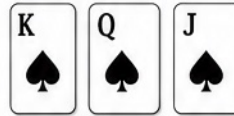
Will become a winner after a maneuver.



3 EQUIVALENT CARDS

Contiguous cards form a sequence.

Example: KQJ



All equivalent!

4 VISUAL EXAMPLE

AKQ = 3 WINNERS



KQJ10 = 0 WINNERS
BUT 3 ESTABLISHABLE



(AFTER THE ACE FALLS)

5 LONG SIDE RULE

The maximum number of tricks you can take in a hand is equal to the number of cards in your longer side.



6 DIAGRAM EXAMPLE

North has J109.
South has AKQ.

✗ NOT 6 TRICKS!

✓ ONLY 3 TRICKS!



WHY ONLY 3 TRICKS?

North can take at most 3 tricks. After South's A, K, Q are gone, North's J, 10, 9 can take only 3 more tricks.

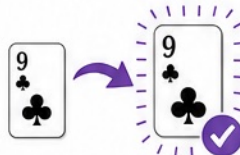
Total = 3 tricks



7 STRATEGY

First develop the establishable cards, then cash the winners!

1 DEVELOP ESTABLISHABLE CARDS



2 THEN CASH YOUR WINNERS



3 MORE TRICKS, BETTER RESULT!





LESSON 02:

THE DEFENDERS' PERSPECTIVE

1 DEFENDERS' GOAL

DEFEAT THE CONTRACT
(Reach a total of **14** tricks)



2 OPENING LEAD IN NO TRUMP

CHOOSE THE LONGEST SUIT



If tied, lead from an honor (Ace, King, Queen, or Jack).



3 RULE 1 - LEAD FROM THE TOP

WHEN YOU HAVE A SEQUENCE

Lead the highest card.



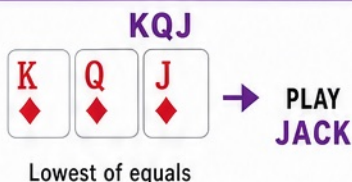
4 RULE 2 - LEAD FROM THE BOTTOM

WHEN YOU DO NOT HAVE A SEQUENCE
Lead the lowest card.



5 THIRD HAND

PLAY THE LOWEST OF EQUALS
(Do not win your partner's trick.)



6 SECOND POSITION RULE



LOW ON LOW
Play a low card against a low card.



COVER HONOR WITH HONOR
Use an honor to cover an honor.

LOW ON LOW (Example)

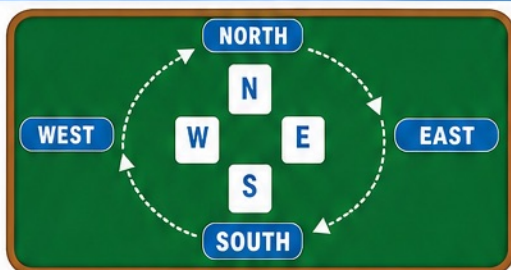


COVER HONOR WITH HONOR (Example)



7 THE ORDER OF PLAY IN A TRICK

Each trick is played clockwise.
First lead, then North, East, South.



- 1 West leads
- 2 North plays
- 3 East plays
- 4 South plays



Lesson 03: Establishing Tricks by Length and Position

1. THREE TYPES OF ESTABLISHING TRICKS



BY STRENGTH



BY LENGTH



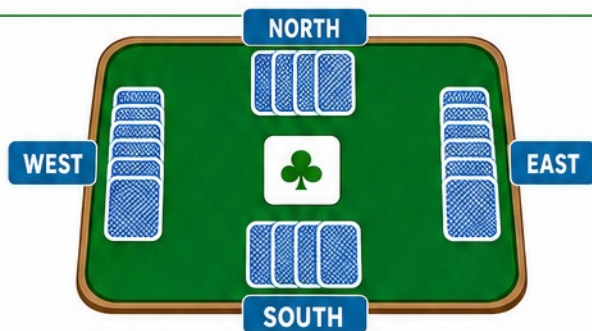
BY POSITION



2 ESTABLISHING BY LENGTH



With many cards, after a few rounds the small ones become winners.



3 EXAMPLE

A K Q 4 3
♠

+

7 6 2
♠

AFTER 3 ROUNDS

THE LAST 2 CARDS ARE ESTABLISHED

2 3
♠

4 COMMUNICATIONS

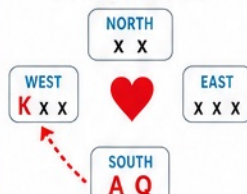
Entries are needed to cash the established cards.



NO ENTRY = WINNERS STAY LOCKED

5 FINESSE

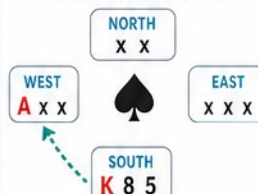
Play TOWARDS a protected honor.
Example: AQ towards the Queen, hoping for the King on the left.



SUCCESS CHANCE: 50%

6 EXPASSE

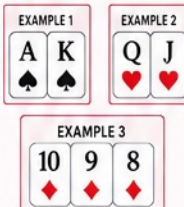
Play TOWARDS an unprotected honor.
Example: K85, play towards the King hoping for the Ace on the left.



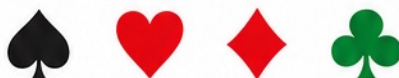
BEST CHANCE: ACE IS TRUMP

7 HOLDING (DEFENSE)

A figure that prevents the opponents from establishing tricks.



GOOD DEFENSE PROTECTS THE DEAL





FIGB

LESSON 04: NO TRUMP PLAY PLAN

1. THE 3 QUESTIONS OF THE PLAY PLAN

1 How many winners do I have?



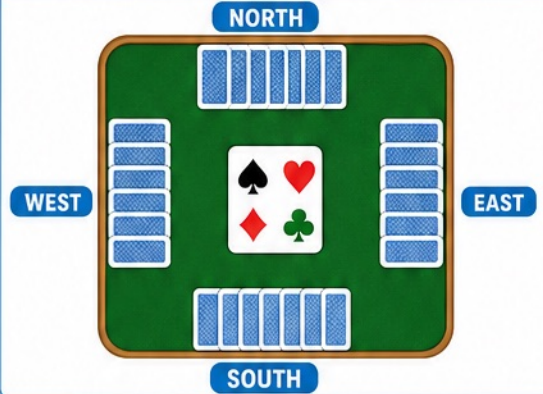
2 How many do I need?



3 In which suit can I find them?

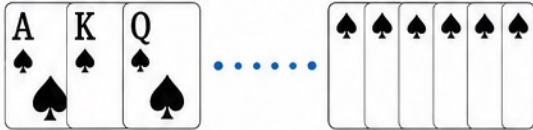


BRIDGE TABLE - POINTS OF VIEW



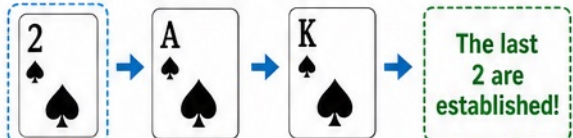
2. PRESERVE ENTRIES

Don't waste high cards near the long suit.



3. THE DUCK

Give up a trick immediately to maintain communication.



4. EXAMPLE: AK6 + 86532

YOUR HAND



1. PLAY THE 2 (DUCK)



Give up one trick to keep the line of communication.

2. THEN PLAY THE A



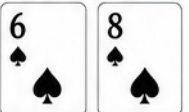
Take a trick.

3. THEN PLAY THE K



Take another trick.

4. THE LAST 2 ARE ESTABLISHED!



You can now take the last two tricks.

5. BLOCKED SUITS

Honors from the short side first!

(e.g., K2 + AQJ43 → King first!)



Play the King first!

6. RACE TO ESTABLISH

Whoever develops first wins.



Be the first to establish your tricks!

7. PLAY PLAN SUMMARY

1 COUNT YOUR WINNERS
How many winners do I have?



2 SET YOUR GOAL
How many do I need?



3 FIND YOUR SOURCE
In which suit can I find them?



4 MAKE A PLAN
Decide the line of play.



5 PLAY CAREFULLY
Preserve entries, use the duck, and unblock suits.



6 ESTABLISH YOUR TRICKS
Race to establish and win!



SPADES



HEARTS



DIAMONDS



CLUBS

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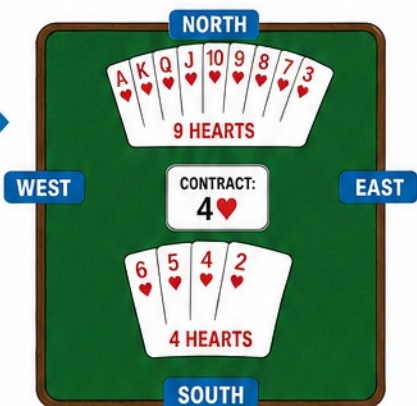
Lesson 05: Playing with Trumps

1 THE FIT

8+ cards in one suit between the 2 hands → that suit becomes **TRUMP**

EXAMPLE

9 hearts (North)
+ 4 hearts (South)
= 13 hearts
→ **HEARTS**
become **TRUMP**



2 PRIORITY



Spades / Hearts (**major**)
> No Trump > Clubs / Diamonds (**minor**)

3 THE 3 POWERS OF TRUMPS



1. CONTROL

Ruff opponents' winners



Ruff the King of Spades with the **Ace of Hearts**.



2. LENGTHENING

Gain more tricks by ruffing from the short hand



South is **short** in Diamonds. Ruffing in the short hand preserves trumps in the **long** hand (North) to take more tricks.



3. ESTABLISHING

Ruff to establish a long suit



Ruff in **hearts**, then lead hearts from North to establish a long heart suit.

4 DRAWING TRUMPS



Remove opponents' trumps before cashing long suits.

Why?

So your long suits won't be ruffed by the opponents.

Draw trumps first

Then cash your long suits



5 REEVALUATION

For a single hand, **NEVER** on the total fit.

With fit, add distribution points of the **RESPONDER**:

K	7	Doubleton	+1
K		Singleton	+3
		Void	+5

MAX 5 EXTRA POINTS

6 VISUAL EXAMPLE OF A RUFF

When a player has 0 cards in the suit, they ruff with a trump.



South has no clubs. They ruff the trick with the **Ace of Hearts**.



FIGB

Lesson 06: Trump Play Plan

1 TWO SCENARIOS: CHOOSE YOUR PLAN



**DO YOU HAVE
LONG SUITS
to cash?**

**WHAT IS YOUR
GOAL?**

**DO YOU HAVE
RUFFS
to make?**



**DRAW TRUMPS
FIRST!**



**DON'T DRAW TRUMPS
IMMEDIATELY!**

2 HOW TO BUILD RUFFS

**GIVE UP TRICKS TO CREATE
RUFFING OPPORTUNITIES.**

Lead



Let it win



Now you can ruff!



You made a ruff and kept your trumps!



3 URGENCY



**SOMETIMES EVEN
ONE ROUND OF TRUMPS
WOULD BE FATAL!**

Act quickly when the situation
requires it.

4 REMEMBER THIS RULE



**DECIDING TO DRAW
TRUMPS ≠ DOING IT
IMMEDIATELY.**

Take care of urgent matters
first!

5 DEFENSE AGAINST TRUMP CONTRACTS



**LOOK FOR
QUICK TRICKS**
Cash your winners
as soon as you can.



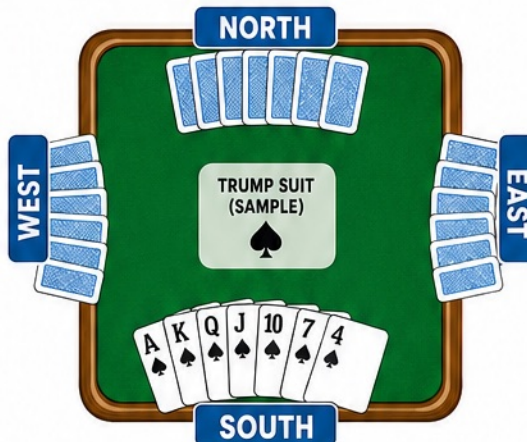
**OPENING LEAD
FROM SEQUENCE**
You only need 2 honors:
KQ, QJ, or J10.



**OPENING LEAD
FROM SHORTNESS**
Lead from a singleton
or doubleton.
Hope for a ruff!



**NEVER LEAD
UNDER AN ACE**
In a trump contract,
lead an Ace or
something else!



**GOOD DEFENSE
HELPS YOUR PARTNER
AND BEATS
THE CONTRACT!**



**BE ACTIVE, THINK
AHEAD, AND
COMMUNICATE
WITH YOUR LEADS!**



Choosing the opening bid

Five-card majors, four-card diamonds. Reference: FIGB Fiori 2022, pages 24–27.

With a balanced hand (4333, 4432, 5332), check the high-card point range first:

HCP	Opening
15–17	1NT
21–23	2NT
24 or more	2♣, then describe the balanced hand

With balanced 12–14 or 18–20 HCP, open a suit: a major requires five cards; otherwise 1♦ requires four diamonds, or open 1♣ even with only two clubs.

With an unbalanced 12–20 HCP: open the only long suit, or, with two suits both at least five cards long, the higher-ranking suit as specified in Fiori 2022.

Strong suit openings: 21+ HCP or about 8½–9 winners. The suit must be six cards long, or five with another suit of at least four cards. Counting winners is different from counting HCP.

2♣ is ambiguous: a balanced 24+ HCP or a strong club-based hand. Strong suit openings are forcing for one round: responder must not pass.

Example: ♠J ♥KQJ74 ♦AK4 ♣AQ63 = 20 HCP. It is not balanced: the ordinary opening is 1♥, not 1♣ and not automatically 2♥.

Notrump and Stayman

Reference: FIGB Fiori 2022, pages 28–30. 1NT: 15–17 HCP. 2NT: 21–23 HCP. Both require a balanced hand.

Fiori uses natural suit responses. Transfers are additional agreements and must be explicitly stated in an exercise.

Stayman looks for a 4–4 major-suit fit. Ask with 2♣ over 1NT or 3♣ over 2NT. There are four responses:

Opener's shape	Over 2♣	Over 3♣
No four-card major	2♦	3♦
Four hearts, not four spades	2♥	3♥
Four spades, not four hearts	2♠	3♠
Both four-card majors	2NT	3NT

In this system, 2NT is a Stayman response over 1NT. Likewise, 3NT is a Stayman response over 2NT: both show both four-card majors.

Do not confuse roles and sequences: responder's direct 3NT over 2NT chooses a contract; opener's 3NT after 3♣ describes both four-card majors.

Example: over 2NT, ♠43 ♥K52 ♦AJ952 ♣976 has 8 HCP. The partnership has 29–31 HCP and no four-card major to explore: bid 3NT.

Agreements from other editions or advanced courses do not automatically apply to this system.



FIGB

LESSON 09: OPENING 1 OF A SUIT - THE RESPONSES

1 PASS



PASS

0-4 POINTS

GAME
IMPOSSIBLE

2 SUPPORT (WITH FIT)

LEVEL 2
(5-9 PTS)

= LIMIT



LEVEL 3
(10-11 PTS)

= INVITATIONAL



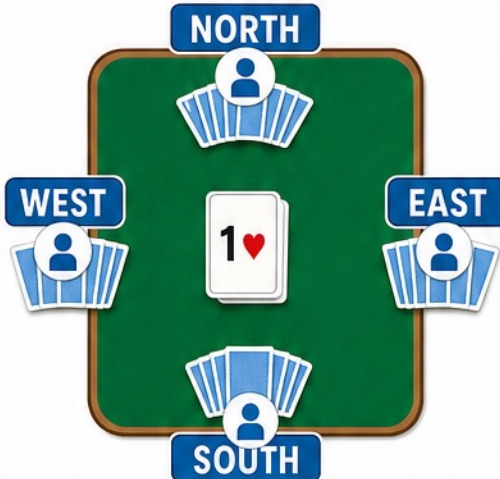
LEVEL 4
(FIT 4+,
MAX 11 PTS)

= GAME



3 NEW SUITS AT LEVEL 1

- ✓ 5+ POINTS
- ✓ 4+ CARDS
- ✓ FORCING



4 NEW SUITS AT LEVEL 2

- ✓ 12+ POINTS
- ✓ GAME FORCING



5 RESPONSES TO NOTRUMP

1NT	5-10 POINTS	NON-FORCING
2NT	11 POINTS	INVITATIONAL
3NT	12-15 POINTS	GAME

NT

6 REEVALUATION LAW

WITH FIT 4+,
ADD
(TRUMP CARDS -
SHORTEST SUIT)



**WITH 5+ POINTS:
YOU MUST ALWAYS RESPOND!**



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LESSON 10: THE OPENER DESCRIBES

1. TWO STRENGTH RANGES

DIRECT
12–15
POINTS



REVERSE
16–20
POINTS

2. SAFETY LEVEL (SL)



The last
“**SAFE**”
contract.

3. BALANCED DIRECT

Stay below

1NT



4. UNBALANCED DIRECT

Stay below

“**2 OF THEIR SUIT**”



5. REVERSE: ALWAYS EXCEEDS THE SAFETY LEVEL



Jump shift

(e.g., 1♣–1♦
→ 2♠ = reverse!)

SOUTH	NORTH
1♣	1♦
2♠	= REVERSE!



Support
at level 3

SOUTH	NORTH
1♥	1♠
3♥	= REVERSE!



Balanced
18–20:
jump to 2NT

SOUTH	NORTH
1♣	1♦
2NT	= REVERSE!

6. AFTER A 2 OVER 1 RESPONSE

SOUTH	NORTH
1♥	2♠



DESCRIBES ONLY DISTRIBUTION
(GAME ALREADY GUARANTEED)

7. RESPONSES AND OPENER'S REBIDS

SOUTH OPENS 1♥

RESPONDER (NORTH)

1♠

2♣

2♦

2♥

2♠

2NT

3♣ / 3♦ / 3♥ / 3♠

OPENER (SOUTH) REBIDS

Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

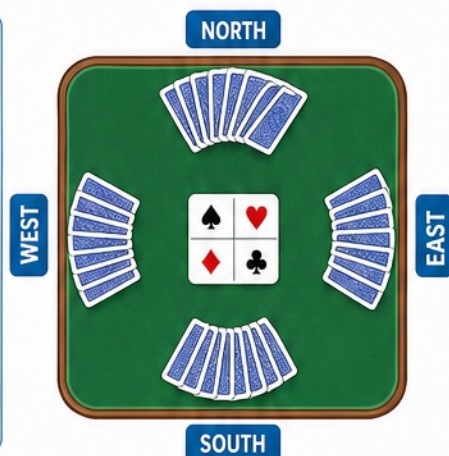
Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♠ (showing a long spade suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 3♥
No support: 3♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 3♥
No support: 3♠ (showing a long spade suit)

Balanced hand: choose game or invite (3NT / 4♥)

Preemptive: bid your best contract



KEY TAKEAWAY: The opener's rebid describes strength and distribution.
Know the rules, watch the Safety Level, and communicate clearly!

LESSON 11: THE OVERCALL

1 THREE TYPES OF OVERCALL

TAKEOUT DOUBLE



- ★ 12-16 HCP
- ★ SHORT (0-2 cards) in the opponent's suit
- ★ At least 3 cards in every other suit



WARNING: the takeout double does NOT promise a balanced hand!

Balanced hands with a stopper bid 1NT.

1NT

15-17 balanced
+
STOPPER in the opponent's suit



SUIT BID

- ★ 8-16 HCP
- ★ 5+ cards
- +
1+ Honor



2 WHAT DOUBLES PROMISE



DOUBLE over 1♣/1♦



guarantees 4♥ and 4♠

DOUBLE over 1♥



guarantees 4♠

DOUBLE over 1♠



guarantees 4♥

3 PARTNER OF THE DOUBLER



MUST BID

(even with 0 points!)

4 PARTNER OF THE OVERCALLER



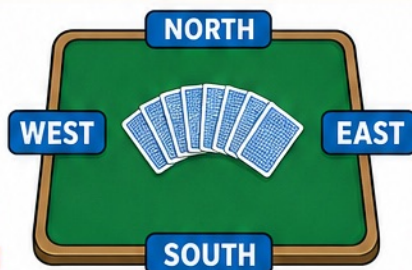
WITH
9+ POINTS
NEVER
PASS



5 GOLDEN RULE



IF PARTNER WILL LEAD
IN YOUR SUIT AND
IT MAKES YOUR
HAIR STAND ON END
→ **WRONG OVERCALL!**





FIGB

LESSON 12: DEVELOPMENTS AFTER OPPONENT'S INTERVENTION

1 FORCED vs FREE

With opponent's intervention, you are **no longer forced** to bid.



2 ON OPPONENT'S DOUBLE

XX

REDOUBLE = 11+ points
(only strong bid)



New suit = **NON-forcing**,
good 5–6 card suit,
< 11 points



Raises = as before,
but < 11 points

3 ON OPPONENT'S SUIT



New suit = **FORCING**
and at least FIVE (5+ cards)

XX

DOUBLE = looking for
4-4 fit, promises 8+ points

NT

No-trump = promises
a **STOPPER** in
opponent's suit

4 FOURTH HAND:

The opener can **PASS**
if partner has responded.



5 OPENING NO-TRUMP RESPONSE WITH A STOPPER

1NT (7–10 POINTS)	2NT (11–12 POINTS)	3NT (13–14 POINTS)
ALL WITH STOPPER	ALL WITH STOPPER	ALL WITH STOPPER
   	   	   

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